

Trophy

Boavista Settles All Three Races

Not one of the three competitions changed leader on the final day, which left Friday to decide only the size of the margins and which of Stuart Neumann and Henry Meller would carry the Spoon home.

On the final day at Boavista the TEG 3 Trophy went to Jon Baker, but three other stories closed out around him. David Mullin secured the TEG 3 Green Jacket, his second, extending his lead from nine shots to twelve. He built the round on a tidy stretch from the 2nd to the 4th. Three holes without dropping a gross shot, three shots gained to net par, the golf of a man who had read the situation correctly. Then came the 5th, and a triple bogey, and the end of all that. At the 11th he added a quadruple bogey, apparently to test whether twelve shots was really necessary. It was not. Neither dent cost him the Jacket.

Stuart Neumann kept himself off the bottom with a small run of his own. Two holes without a dropped shot, around the 6th and 7th. It was enough to survive a near-miss with the TEG 3 Wooden Spoon, which is not the same thing as playing well.

Henry Meller could not escape it. From the 12th to the 15th he gained shots to par four times in succession, narrowing the gap to fourth from five to four. It was a rally staged in a building that had already been condemned. Meller finished with his second Wooden Spoon.

AT A GLANCE
Trophy Winner Jon Baker
Green Jacket David Mullin
Wooden Spoon Henry Meller

Round Net VP
JB 0 DM +2 HM +4 GW +5 SN +5
Round Gross
DM +20 SN +23 HM +24 JB +28 GW +35

After R4 • Trophy
JB -18 DM 0 GW +7 SN +12 HM +16
After R4 • Green Jacket
DM +72 SN +84 JB +94 HM +96 GW +127

Jon Baker

Baker Best Or Tied All Four

A level-net round was the best score on Friday and left Baker with the best or tied-best score in all four rounds, closing out the week that began with the -9 that stands as the best round in TEG history.

Jon Baker's final round at Boavista Golf & Spa Resort completed a TEG 3 with the best or tied-best score in every round. His level-net 0 was the best score in the field. The Trophy is his, for the first time.

The round turned through holes 7 to 9, where he picked up four shots against par. The key blow

was a net birdie on the par-5 8th, one of the hardest holes on the course, delivered off nothing more exotic than a gross par. He then went through the 8th and the 9th without dropping a gross shot. It was control, applied without ceremony, on an afternoon when three other men were being dismantled by the 17th.

It left Jon Baker as Trophy leader after the round, with David Mullin leading the separate Green Jacket race. Baker's overall Trophy lead grew to 18 shots by the finish. He began the day in front and ended it further in front, which is what four rounds as the field's best or joint-best will do. It was his seventh visit to Boavista. Not a course best for him this TEG. Enough to finish the job.

Boavista

Boavista's Easiest Hole Takes Another Ten

Rated seventeenth hardest of eighteen, the hole has now produced a 12 from Henry Meller, a 9 from David Mullin and a sextuple bogey from Stuart Neumann inside four days.

The 17th at Boavista carries stroke index 17. Officially, it is the easiest test on the course. In round four of TEG 3 it worked its way through the field like a man collecting a debt.

Henry Meller ran up a 12. David Mullin carded a 9. Stuart Neumann arrived last and posted a 10, a sextuple bogey against a par of 4. Three players, one hole, no survivors.

Neumann's was the most costly relative to expectation, six shots added to par on a hole with almost no business allowing it. It stood as his worst score against par of the round. The wider damage of his day was already done by the time he got there, which is its own kind of mercy. None of it changed the shape of the race. Jon Baker stayed clear at the top of the Trophy, Mullin still led the Green Jacket, and Meller remained anchored to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon. The 17th simply took what it was owed from three separate men in one afternoon. That made it the defining scene of the round.

Gregg Williams

Three Quadruple Bogeys, One Respectable Net

The handicap absorbed a 35-over gross round that included the same closing collapse over the last four holes that undid him on Tuesday.

Gregg Williams closed out round four at Boavista with a gross 35-over. It was the worst gross score recorded in the five-man field that day. It was also his third-best net round in seven, which tells you where the pain was living.

The round rested on three quadruple bogeys, spaced out like scheduled maintenance. A 9 at the par-5 3rd. An 8 at the par-4 7th. Another 8 at the par-4 12th. Between the first two, holes 4 to 6 went unexpectedly well. Three straight bogeys, and with strokes received, three shots gained against par. Williams had found the one register in which he was competent, and then left it.

The finish offered nothing. He bled nine shots over the closing four holes. Double bogeys at the 15th, 16th and 18th, with a triple at the 17th sitting in the middle of them. The 15th is Boavista's hardest hole and the 18th one of its toughest, so at least the collapse had taste.

Records & Personal Bests

Notable achievements: TEG 3, Round 4

Rare Feats

— Stuart Neumann runs up a 10 (+6) at the 17th — his career-worst on a par-4